West Berlin, they got a bitter taste of the political system of capitalism. In brutal police attacks, ninety-six young people were injured. This too was part of the scene in those days.’13

In reality, he was embarrassed by the incident and reportedly paid a personal call on Ulbricht to apologise. The Politburo lamented Honecker’s impulsiveness, calling it reckless and irresponsible. In FDJ circles too, it went down badly.